HTML & CSS Master Reference Cheatsheet

Every single tag, property, input type, semantic element, box model component, and code example from source

HTML ESSENTIAL TAGS

Tag	Description
`<!DOCTYPE html>`	Defines document type and HTML version
`<html> </html>`	Defines the root of an HTML document
`<head> </head>`	Contains meta info about document
`<title> </title>`	Sets title of the document (browser tab)
`<body> </body>`	Contains all the content of the document
`<h1> to <h6>`	Headings (h1 = most important, h6 = least)
`<p> </p>`	Defines a paragraph
`<a> </a>`	Defines a hyperlink
`<img>`	Embeds an image
`<ul> </ul>`	Unordered (bulleted) list
`<ol> </ol>`	Ordered (numbered) list
`<li> </li>`	List item
`<div> </div>`	Block-level container (division)
`<span> </span>`	Inline container
` `	Line break
`<hr>`	Horizontal rule (thematic break)
`<table> </table>`	Defines a table
`<tr> </tr>`	Table row
`<th> </th>`	Table header cell
`<td> </td>`	Table data cell
`<form> </form>`	Defines an HTML form
`<input>`	Input field (text, checkbox, radio, etc.)
`<button> </button>`	Clickable button
`<label> </label>`	Label for an input element
`<textarea> </textarea>`	Multi-line text input field
`<select> </select>`	Drop-down list
`<option> </option>`	Option in a drop-down list
`<!-- -->`	Comment (not displayed in browser)

CSS ESSENTIAL PROPERTIES

Property	Description
`color`	Sets the text color
`background-color`	Sets the background color
`font-size`	Sets the text size
`font-family`	Sets the font
`font-weight`	Sets the boldness (normal, bold, 100-900)
`text-align`	Aligns text (left, center, right, justify)
`text-decoration`	Adds decoration (none, underline, etc.)
`line-height`	Sets the height of a line
`letter-spacing`	Sets spacing between letters
`word-spacing`	Sets spacing between words
`margin`	Sets space outside the element
`padding`	Sets space inside the element
`width`	Sets the width of an element
`height`	Sets the height of an element
`border`	Shorthand for border-width, style, color
`border-radius`	Rounds the corners of an element
`box-shadow`	Adds shadow around an element
`display`	Sets display type (block, inline, flex, grid)
`position`	Sets position type (static, relative, absolute)
`top / right / bottom / left`	Offsets positioned elements
`float`	Floats an element (left, right, none)
`clear`	Specifies what elements can float beside
`overflow`	Controls content overflow (visible, hidden, etc.)
`opacity`	Sets opacity (0.0 fully transparent to 1.0 opaque)
`z-index`	Sets the stacking order of an element
`cursor`	Sets the mouse cursor style
`transition`	Adds a smooth transition effect
`transform`	Transforms element (rotate, scale, translate)

BOX MODEL, DISPLAY TYPES & UNITS

Box Model: margin (space outside) → border → padding (space inside) → content (width x height).

Display Type	Description / Behavior
block	Takes full width, starts on a new line.
inline	Takes only needed width, stays in the same line.
inline-block	Like inline, but you can set width and height.
flex	Flexible box layout.
grid	Grid layout (rows & columns).

Useful Units:

`px` – Pixels (fixed size)
`%` – Percentage (relative to parent)
`em` – Relative to parent font size
`rem` – Relative to root html font size
`vh` – 1% of viewport height
`vw` – 1% of viewport width

COMMON INPUT TYPES & HTML5 SEMANTICS

Type	Description
`text`	Single-line text input
`password`	Password field
`email`	Email input
`number`	Number input
`checkbox`	Checkbox
`radio`	Radio button
`submit`	Submit form
`reset`	Reset form
`date`	Date picker
`file`	File upload

HTML5 Semantic Elements:

`<header>` Header of a section or page
`<nav>` Navigation links
`<main>` Main content of the document
`<section>` Section in a document
`<article>` Independent, self-contained content
`<aside>` Sidebar or related content
`<footer>` Footer of a section or page

COMPLETE HTML EXAMPLE

```html
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <title>My Page</title>
</head>
<body>
  <header>
    <h1>Welcome to My Website</h1>
    <nav>
      <a href="#">Home</a> |
      <a href="#">About</a> |
      <a href="#">Contact</a>
    </nav>
  </header>
  <main>
    <section>
      <h2>About Us</h2>
      <p>This is a paragraph about our website.</p>
    </section>
    <img src="image.jpg" alt="Example Image" width="400">
    <form action="#" method="post">
      <label for="name">Name:</label><br>
      <input type="text" id="name" name="name" required><br>
      <label for="email">Email:</label><br>
      <input type="email" id="email" name="email" required><br>
      <button type="submit">Send</button>
    </form>
  </main>
  <footer>
    <p>&copy; 2024 My Website</p>
  </footer>
</body>
</html>
```

COMPLETE CSS EXAMPLE

```css
body {
  font-family: 'Arial', sans-serif;
  background-color: #f4f6f8;
  color: #333;
  line-height: 1.6;
  margin: 0;
  padding: 0;
}
header {
  background-color: #4a6fa5;
  color: white;
  padding: 20px;
  text-align: center;
}
nav a {
  color: white;
  text-decoration: none;
  margin: 0 15px;
  font-weight: bold;
}
main {
  width: 90%;
  max-width: 1000px;
  margin: 30px auto;
  padding: 20px;
  background: white;
  border-radius: 8px;
  box-shadow: 0 4px 12px rgba(0,0,0,0.1);
}
button {
  background-color: #4a6fa5;
  color: white;
  padding: 10px 18px;
  border: none;
  border-radius: 4px;
  cursor: pointer;
  transition: background 0.3s ease;
}
button:hover {
  background-color: #365783;
}
```

BEST PRACTICES

- Use semantic HTML for better structure and SEO.
- Keep your HTML clean and well-indented.
- Use external CSS for better maintainability.
- Use meaningful class and ID names.
- Follow the DRY principle (Don't Repeat Yourself).
- Test your website on different screen sizes.